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Ran Takahashi

Ran Takahashi (高橋 藍 or たかはしらん, *Takahashi Ran*; born 2 September 2001) is a Japanese volleyball player who currently plays as an outside hitter for SV League club Suntory Sunbirds, which he captains, and the Japan men's national volleyball team.

He previously played for Pallavolo Padova and Vero Volley Monza in the Italian Volleyball League, as well as Nippon Sport Science University at collegiate level.^{[1][2]}

Biography

Ran Takahashi was born on 2 September 2001 in Kyoto Prefecture, Japan. His mother is Japanese of part British and German descent, and his father is Japanese. Ran has one brother, Rui, who is one and a half year older, and one younger sister, Riri. He started playing volleyball following the footsteps of his brother. His sister also plays volleyball.^[3]

Career

Elementary School Years

Ran started playing volleyball in his second grade of elementary school for the school's team.^[4]

High School Years

Ran played for Kyoto Municipal Hachigaoka Junior High School. Because of his height, in the first grade, he was mainly used as a Libero.

Afterward, he attended Higashiyama High School, and he was in the starting line up in high school since his first year and served as

Ran Takahashi



Personal information

Full name	Ran Takahashi
Nationality	<u>Japanese</u>
Born	<u>2 September 2001</u> <u>Kyoto, Japan</u>
Height	188 cm (6 ft 2 in)
Weight	84 kg (185 lb)
Spike	343 cm (135 in)
Block	315 cm (124 in)
College / University	<u>Nippon Sport Science University</u>

Volleyball information

Position	Outside Hitter
Current club	<u>Suntory Sunbirds</u>
Number	12 (National) 13 (University) 12 (Club)

Career

Years	Teams
2017–2020	● <u>Higashiyama High School</u>
2020–2024	● <u>Nippon Sport Science University</u>
2021–2023	🇮🇹 <u>Pallavolo Padova</u>
2023–2024	🇮🇹 <u>Vero Volley Monza</u>

an ace and captain of his team by the third year. He led his team to the Top 4 of the National High School Sports Championship, also known as *"Inter-High"*. His team also won the 2019 National Sports Festival (*Kokutai*) of Japan, as well as the 2020 All Japan High School Volleyball Championship, also known as *"Haruko."* In addition, he received the "Most Valuable Player" award at the end of the competition.^{[5][6]}

He has no under category experience at all, but he was immediately elected as a senior representative in February 2020 while he was still in the 3rd grade of high school.^{[7][8]}

College Years and International Success

After graduating from high school, Takahashi entered Nippon Sport Science University. He led the team, receiving the Runner-Up place in the 2020 All Japan Intercollegiate Volleyball Championship, and got the Best Scorer award from the competition.^[9] In 2021, he was one of the Outside Hitters for the Japan men's national volleyball team at the 2020 Summer Olympics held in Tokyo, Japan.^[10]

After winning 2nd place at the Asian Men's Volleyball Championship with the Japan men's national volleyball team, he returned to play for his college team in the 2021 Kanto University Men's Division 1 League, winning 1st place by defeating Waseda University in straight sets.^[11] He also played for his college team in the 2021 All Japan Intercollegiate Volleyball Championship, but lost in the quarterfinals against Jutendo University.^[12]

On November 29, it was announced that Takahashi would play in the Italian Volleyball League Division 1 with Pallavolo Padova.^[13] He arrived Italy on December and signed 14 as his jersey number, the same as Yūki Ishikawa's when he played with Padova.

On December 19, Ran debuted in the Italian Volleyball League as a substitute in the third set against Modena Volley.^{[14][15]} Pallavolo Padova announced that Ran has renewed his contract with the club for Season 2022–2023.^[16] He was nominated as MVP of the match against Valsa Group Modena for the first time in the Italian league.^[17]

From 2023 until 2024, Vero Volley Monza signed with Ran Takahashi for the Italian Volleyball League.^[18] He later signed with Suntory Sunbirds and is set to make his debut in the Japanese Volleyball League.

At the 2024 Summer Olympics held in Paris, France, Takahashi made his second Olympics appearance alongside Japan men's national volleyball team. They reached the quarterfinals but eventually lost to Italy

2024–2026

Suntory Sunbirds

National team

2021–present

Japan

Medal Record

Men's Volleyball

Representing Japan

FIVB Nations League

S

2024 Łódź

Team

B

2023 Gdańsk

Team

Asian Championship

G

2023 Urmia

Team

S

2021 Chiba/Funabashi

Team

YouTube information

Channel

RanRui (<https://www.youtube.com/@らんるい>)

Years active

2021–present

Genre

Vlog

Subscribers

366 thousand

Views

29 million

Last updated: May 31, 2026

Last updated: May 31, 2026

Clubs

-  Higashiyama High School (2017–2020)
-  Nippon Sport Science University (2020–2024)^[20]
-  Pallavolo Padova (2021–2023)^{[21][22]}
-  Vero Volley Monza (2023–2024)
-  Suntory Sunbirds (2024–2026)

Personal Life

Ran Takahashi: The First Photobook, a career retrospective, was released on August 22, 2022.^[23]

Awards

Individual

- 2020 All Japan High School Volleyball Championship – Most Valuable Player
- 2020 All Japan Intercollegiate Volleyball Championship – Best Scorer
- 2023 Asian Championship – Best Outside Spiker
- 2023 Anan Awards – Anan Awards for Athlete Category
- 2023–24 Italian Superlega – Best Receiver
- 2024 Emperor's Cup – Most Valuable Player
- 2024–25 SV.League Men's – Finals Most Valuable Player
- 2024–25 SV.League Men's – Best Outside Hitter (Best 6)
- 2024–25 SV.League Men's – Receiver of the Year
- 2024–25 SV.League Men's – Attack the Top Award
- 2025 AVC Men's Champions League – Best Outside Spiker
- 2025–26 SV.League Men's – Best Outside Hitter (Best 6)
- 2025–26 SV.League Men's – Receiver of the Year

High School

- 2020 All Japan High School Volleyball Championship – 🏆 **Champion**, with Higashiyama High School

College

- 2020 All Japan Intercollegiate Volleyball Championship – 🥈 Runner-Up, with Nippon Sport Science University
- 2021 Kanto University Men's Division 1 League – 🏆 **Champion**, with Nippon Sport Science University

National Team

- 2021 Asian Championship – 🥈 Runner-Up
- 2023 Volleyball Nations League – 🥉 3rd Place
- 2023 Asian Championship – 🏆 **Champion**
- 2023 World Cup – 🥈 Runner-Up
- 2024 Volleyball Nations League – 🥈 Runner-Up

Club Team

- Vero Volley Monza**
 - 2023–24 Italian Superlega – 🥈 Runner-Up
 - 2023–24 Coppa Italia – 🥈 Runner-Up
 - 2023–24 CEV Challenge Cup – 🥈 Runner-Up
- Suntory Sunbirds**
 - 2024 Emperor's Cup – 🏆 **Champion**
 - 2024–25 SV.League Men's – 🏆 **Champion**
 - 2024–25 SV.League Men's – 🥈 Regular Season Runner-Up
 - 2025 AVC Champions League – 🥉 3rd Place
 - 2025–26 SV.League Men's – 🥈 Runner-Up
 - 2025–26 SV.League Men's – 🥇 Regular Season Champion

Ambassadorship

Takahashi's brand ambassadorships include French luxury fashion house Dior, Japanese sportswear Asics, Japanese makeup brand Kosé, and Filipino electronics company Akari.^{[24][25]}

Alongside his brother Rui, Ran also serves as an official Kyoto Prefecture Cultural Tourism Ambassador since May 2025.^[26]

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 - Ran Takahashi (https://olympics.com/en/paris-2024/athlete/ran-takahashi_1918654) at the Paris 2024 Summer Olympics
 - Ran Takahashi (<https://www.instagram.com/ran.volleyball0902/>) on *Instagram*
 - Japan's men's volleyball team might be out of the Olympics, but its star rookie is going viral on Twitter for his slick moves straight out of sports anime 'Haikyuu!!' (<https://www.insider.com/japans-olympic-mens-volleyball-rookie-viral-twitter-anime-style-moves-2021-8>)
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